ZikShare

ACADEMIC VAULT

UNIZIK FRESHER EDITION | 2026

Sexual Health, Consent and Relationships: Decide With Information

Factual, judgement-free guidance on consent, protection and getting care

HEALTH & WELLBEING

Health & Wellbeing

General Studies (GST / CED)
GST Directorate | 100L

Written for students, by students.

Practical notes, worked examples, practice questions and a revision plan.

Study smarter. Ask better questions. Pass with understanding.

Independent study support | Not an official UNIZIK publication

START HERE

Why this pack exists

Freshers receive a lot of rumour and very little accurate information. This pack covers consent, contraception and barrier protection, common sexually transmitted infections, testing and where to get confidential care, with no moralising and no shame.

This is a student-written study companion, not a reproduced lecture handout or a leaked examination paper. Use it to organise the topics you are taught, practise the kind of thinking your course rewards, and walk into class with better questions.

What you will be able to do

- Define consent and describe the conditions that make it valid.
- Compare contraceptive methods and explain barrier protection.
- Recognise common STI symptoms and know that many infections are asymptomatic.
- Identify confidential sources of testing, treatment and support.

How to use this pack

1. Skim the whole pack once in 20 minutes so you know what is inside.
2. Work through one section at a time with your lecture note and recommended text beside you.
3. Attempt the practice questions before reading the answers. Mark what you missed.
4. Use the final checklist to plan your revision week, one tick per study session.

> **Confirm your official course outline**
> Course codes, credit units and outlines can differ by department and session. Treat this pack as supplementary support and confirm the current outline with your lecturer, course rep or departmental handbook before an assessment.

Consent and boundaries

Consent is an ongoing agreement, not a single moment.

- Consent must be freely given, informed, specific and reversible.
- A person can withdraw consent at any time, including during an act.
- Silence, coercion, pressure or intoxication do not constitute consent.
- Marriage or a previous relationship does not remove the need for consent.
- Agreeing to one act does not imply agreement to another.
- Respect a no immediately, and stop if you are unsure.

> **Support after assault**
> Seek medical attention quickly, preserve evidence where possible, and contact a trusted person or support service. What happened is not the survivor's fault.

Protection and contraception

Different methods do different jobs: contraception prevents pregnancy, while barrier protection reduces infection risk.

- Male condoms reduce the risk of pregnancy and most STIs when used correctly and consistently.
- Hormonal methods such as pills and injectables prevent pregnancy but do not protect against infection.
- Long-acting reversible methods are highly effective and require a provider.
- Emergency contraception reduces pregnancy risk after unprotected sex but is not routine contraception.
- Two methods used together give better protection than one alone.
- Consult a health provider before starting any method.

Infections, testing and care

Many STIs have no symptoms, so testing matters more than appearance.

- Common infections include HIV, gonorrhoea, chlamydia, syphilis, herpes and HPV.
- Symptoms can include discharge, sores, pain or burning on urination, but absence of symptoms is common.
- Testing is confidential and available at the university health centre and public facilities.
- Most bacterial STIs are curable with the right treatment; viral infections can be managed.
- Complete a full course of treatment and inform partners where appropriate.
- Never self-medicate with antibiotics from a chemist without testing.

PRACTICE, NOT PREDICTION

Check your understanding

These questions are written for this pack to test the ideas above. They are not past examination questions and do not predict what your lecturer will set. Answer first, then compare.

1. Define valid consent.

Answer: A freely given, informed, specific and reversible agreement, made without coercion and by someone with capacity.

2. Do hormonal contraceptives protect against STIs?

Answer: No. They prevent pregnancy but provide no protection against sexually transmitted infections.

3. Why can you not rely on symptoms to know your STI status?

Answer: Many infections are asymptomatic, so a person can be infected and transmit without any signs.

4. What should you do after unprotected sex where pregnancy is a concern?

Answer: Seek advice about emergency contraception as soon as possible, and get tested for STIs after the appropriate window.

5. Where can a student get confidential testing?

Answer: The university health centre or a public or private clinic; testing and treatment are meant to be confidential.

Your 7-step action plan

Tick each step only when you have done it. A tick you cannot defend is worse than an empty box.

- [ ] Learn the four elements of valid consent.
- [ ] Read about three contraceptive methods and their effectiveness.
- [ ] Locate the campus health centre and its opening hours.
- [ ] Know the window period for HIV and STI testing.
- [ ] Identify one trusted person to talk to about health concerns.
- [ ] Learn how to use a condom correctly.
- [ ] Find the contact details of a support service for assault survivors.

Keep going

One pack will not carry a semester. Pair this with your lecture notes, tutorials, and the past questions your department actually releases. If a topic still feels unclear, take a specific question to your lecturer or course rep - "I do not understand the difference between X and Y" gets a better answer than "I do not understand this course".

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YOUR WORKSPACE

Notes, questions and things to ask

Use this page in class or during revision. Write questions you could not answer instead of copying slides.

Three ideas I can now explain without notes:

A question I still cannot answer:

For my lecturer or course rep:

Next revision action and date:

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